probably forms at the centers of black holes and in the big crunch of our Universe.

black hole. An object (created by the implosion of a star) down which things can fall but out of which nothing can ever escape.

black-hole binary. A binary system made of two black holes.

Blandford–Znajek process. The extraction of rotational energy from a spinning black hole by magnetic fields that thread through the hole.

boosted atomic bomb. An atomic bomb whose explosive power is increased by one or more layers of fusion fuel.

chain reaction. A sequence of fissions of atomic nuclei in which neutrons from one fission trigger additional fissions, and neutrons from those trigger still more fissions, and so on.

Chandrasekhar limit. The maximum mass that a white-dwarf star can have.

chronology protection conjecture. Hawking's conjecture that the laws of physics do not allow time machines.

classical. Subject to the laws of physics that govern macroscopic objects; non–quantum mechanical.

cold, dead matter. Cold matter in which all nuclear reactions have gone to completion, expelling from the matter all the nuclear energy that can possibly be removed.

collapsed star. The name used for a black hole in the West in the 1960s.

conservation law. Any law of physics that says some specific quantity can never change. Examples are conservation of mass and energy (taken together as a single entity via Einstein's $E = Mc^2$), conservation of total electric charge, and conservation of angular momentum (total amount of spin).

corpuscle. The name used for a particle of light in the seventeenth and eighteenth centuries.

cosmic censorship conjecture. The conjecture that the laws of physics prevent naked singularities from forming when an object implodes.

cosmic ray. A particle of matter or antimatter that bombards the Earth from space. Some cosmic rays are produced by the Sun, but most are created in distant regions of our Milky Way galaxy, perhaps in hot clouds of gas that are ejected into interstellar space by supernovae.

cosmic string. A hypothetical one-dimensional, string-like object that is made from a warpage of space. The string has no ends (either it is